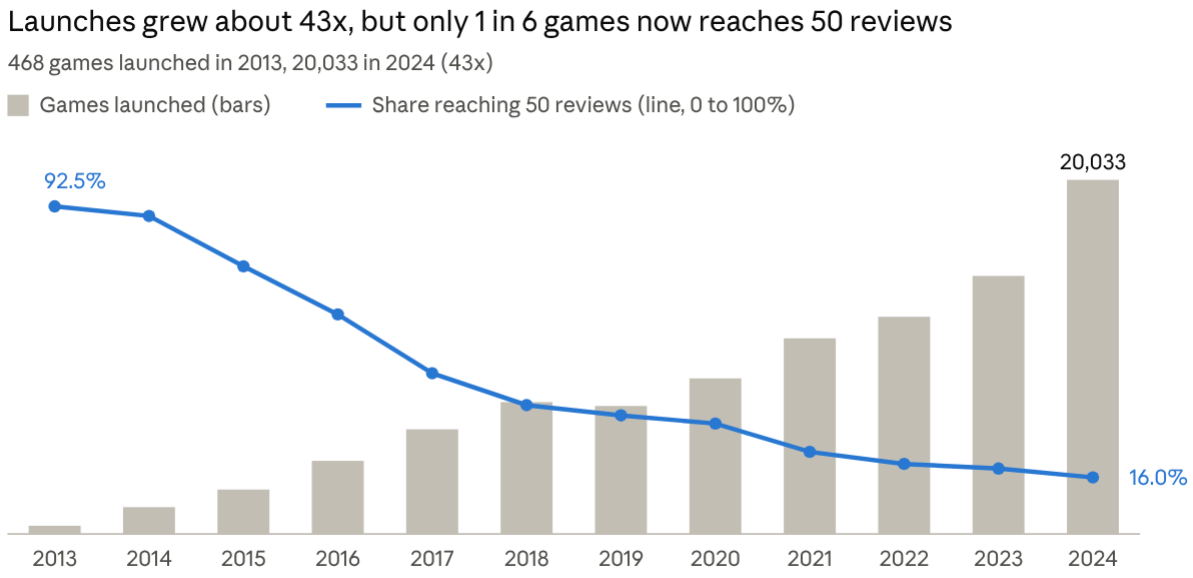
Launch proposal: getting a story-led game noticed on Steam

Recommendation

1. **Position the game as Story Rich**, and Atmospheric if it fits, in its store page and tags, rather than relying on the broad Adventure or Indie labels.
2. **Price it between $10 and $19.99.** Do not go under $5.
3. **Launch in September**, and avoid July.

The problem: more games, the same attention



Source: Steam Games Dataset (Fronkon Games), all 125,855 listings, 2013 to 2024 releases

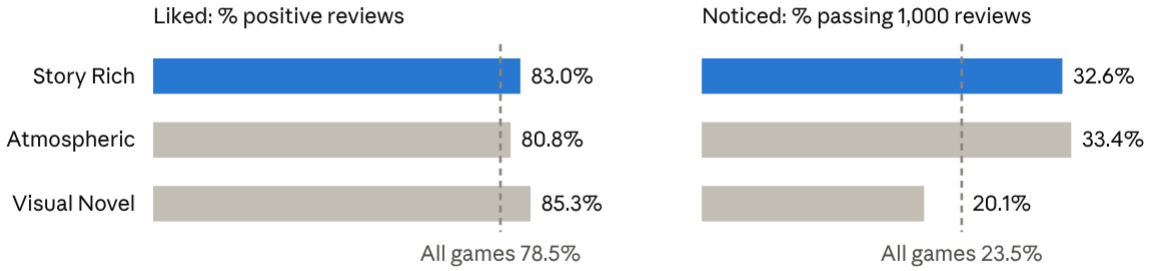
The number of games reaching 50 reviews has stayed at roughly 2,400 to 3,200 a year since 2016, while launches multiplied. Being noticed is now the main launch risk, so each part of the recommendation is about discoverability.

The evidence

Two measures are used: **liked**, the average share of positive reviews, and **noticed**, the share of games passing 1,000 reviews, which counts each game once so a few huge hits cannot distort it.

Story Rich games are better liked and noticed more often than average

Story-led Steam tags against all games with 50+ reviews



Source: Steam Games Dataset (Fronkon Games), 30,624 games with 50+ reviews

- **Positioning.** Story Rich beats the all-games average on both measures, across 6,928 games (chart above). The broad Adventure genre does not: it is noticed no more often than average (23.7%) and is crowded with 13,191 games.
- **Price.** Among Story Rich games, $10 to $19.99 is among the best liked (85.1%) and noticed more often than cheaper games (37.4%, against 28.6% under $5). Under $5 is the most crowded band (3,408 games) and the weakest on attention.
- **Timing.** September had the highest share of games passing 1,000 reviews, both for all games released 2018 to 2024 (27.4%) and for Story Rich games (38.8%). July was among the weakest in both. Liking barely changes by month, so timing affects visibility, not reception.

Risks and limits

- The comparisons cover the 30,624 games with at least 50 reviews, so they describe games that were already noticed.
- Prices are today's prices, not launch prices, and some well-known games appear discounted.
- Steam tags are partly applied by players, and pricier games are often bigger productions, so these are links, not proof of cause. The $20+ bands are noticed more but are small groups (192 and 74 Story Rich games).
- Monthly gaps are a few points on groups of about 500 games, so September is a pattern to test, not a guarantee.

Next steps with our own data

1. Compare wishlist-to-purchase conversion at $14.99 and $19.99.
2. A/B test store page tags and copy that lead with the story.

3. Track wishlist growth in the months before a September launch, and compare it with similar Story Rich games.

About this analysis

Public data on 125,855 Steam listings (Steam Games Dataset by Fronkon Games, MIT licence), analysed in MySQL. I fixed a file header that shifted every value by one column and used a measure that a few hits cannot distort. Full SQL and method: github.com/serenacheng01/steam-launch-analysis